COIN APPRAISAL REGISTER — M2 ARCHITECTURE

Primary Database: Options Comparison

System of record for deal data, customer records, and configuration — Airtable versus a dedicated Postgres database.

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The build specification (Section 2.14) calls for standard data types, no business logic in database formulas, and all workflow running in Make.com. The comparison below weighs keeping Airtable as the system of record against moving deal and customer data to a dedicated Postgres database (Supabase). Make.com continues to orchestrate all workflow in either case.

Criterion	Airtable stays	Supabase / Postgres
System of record	Airtable holds everything	Postgres holds deals + customers
Returning-customer lookup Phone + DOB, real-time at intake	API call, rate-limited (5/sec), slower	Indexed SQL query, instant, no limit
Manager Dashboard Quarterly per-rep aggregations	Painful — compute in Make or client-side	Trivial SQL `GROUP BY`
Approval gate 5-second polling	Polling only	Realtime can push instead of poll
Admin edits config Non-technical operator	Spreadsheet UI — its real strength	Table editor (decent, not as friendly)
Scales to 10k+ deals / multi-location	Degrades, record caps	Effortless
Ongoing cost	~$20–45 / seat / mo	$25 / mo flat (free tier covers early)
Build effort	Lowest	Moderate

RECOMMENDATION

Supabase (Postgres). It makes the two hardest M2 features — the manager dashboard reporting and the returning-customer lookup — fast and clean rather than hacky, scales with the multi-location and roadshow plan, and matches how the specification is written. Make.com still runs all the workflow, so nothing in the agreed architecture changes. Airtable remains the better choice only if direct spreadsheet-style access to live deal data is a firm requirement and deal volume is expected to stay low.